

File Formats & Named Technology Associations

Lesson 55 — Format and Product Matching

JKSSB Computer Awareness

October 8, 2026

Why Formats Matter

- ▶ Every file on a computer is stored in some **format** — a fixed way of arranging its data.
- ▶ The format decides which program can open, read, and edit the file.
- ▶ An **image format** stores a picture; a **document format** stores a printable document.
- ▶ Matching an extension to the right file type and program is a high-yield exam skill.

The one idea

Match **extension** → **format** → **software** — and do not confuse the three.

Extension and Format Are Not the Same

- ▶ The file name ends with an **extension**: the letters after the last dot.
- ▶ Example: in `report.png`, **png** is the extension.
- ▶ The **format** is the way the data inside the file is actually stored.
- ▶ The extension usually signals the format, but the two words mean different things.

Trap alert

“Extension = format” is wrong. `.png` is the **extension**; **PNG** is the **format** (TRM-09, TRAP-34).

Image Formats

- ▶ **PNG** = Portable Network Graphics, an **image** (raster) format.
- ▶ PNG uses **lossless** compression and supports transparency.
- ▶ Other common image formats: **JPEG** (.jpg/.jpeg, lossy) and **GIF** (.gif).
- ▶ Image extensions are .png, .jpg, .jpeg, .gif, .bmp.

Trap alert

PNG is an **image format**, never a document, spreadsheet, or database format.

PDF: Portable Document Format

- ▶ **PDF** = **Portable Document Format**, created by Adobe.
- ▶ It keeps the exact **layout, fonts, and formatting** on every device.
- ▶ Because the page is fixed, it is called a **fixed-layout** format.
- ▶ A PDF may contain real text or be a **scanned image** of a page.

Why PDF is used

PDF is the standard for sharing a document that must look the same everywhere it is opened.

PDF Behaviour and Readers

- ▶ A PDF opens in a **PDF reader**, such as **Adobe Acrobat Reader**.
- ▶ A **web browser** can also display a PDF.
- ▶ A **scanned** PDF is a picture; it needs **OCR** to make its text searchable and selectable.
- ▶ PDF/A is an archival PDF standard for long-term preservation.

Trap alert

A PDF is **not** an editable Word document. Reading and editing are different jobs.

The Office Document Family

Extension	Format	Program
.docx	Word document	Microsoft Word
.xlsx	Excel workbook	Microsoft Excel
.pptx	PowerPoint presentation	Microsoft PowerPoint

These are the modern Office Open XML formats; the older extensions were .doc, .xls, and .ppt.

Plain-Data Formats: CSV and TXT

- ▶ **CSV = Comma-Separated Values.**
- ▶ A CSV file stores a table as **plain text**, with values separated by commas.
- ▶ **TXT** is a plain text file with **no formatting**.
- ▶ Both open in a simple text editor and are not tied to one company.

Keep them apart

CSV looks like a table but is only text; TXT holds characters with no table structure at all.

Microsoft Access: .mdb vs .accdb

- ▶ Both .mdb and .accdb are file extensions for a **Microsoft Access database**.
- ▶ .mdb is the **older** Access database format (Access 2003 and earlier).
- ▶ .accdb is the **newer** Access database format (Access 2007 and later).
- ▶ Both store database objects such as tables, queries, forms, and reports.

Trap alert

.mdb and .accdb are **both Access databases**, not Word or Excel files.

Named Technology: Mozilla and Firefox

- ▶ **Firefox** is a **web browser** developed by **Mozilla**.
- ▶ **Mozilla** is the organisation; **Firefox** is its browser product.
- ▶ Mozilla also makes **Thunderbird**, an email client.
- ▶ Other browsers: Google Chrome, Microsoft Edge, Safari, Opera.

Trap alert

Firefox is by **Mozilla**, not Microsoft. Microsoft's browser is **Edge**.

Named Technology: C-DAC and PARAM

- ▶ **C-DAC** = **Centre for Development of Advanced Computing**.
- ▶ C-DAC is an R&D organisation under **MeitY**, Government of India.
- ▶ **PARAM** is a family of **supercomputers** developed by C-DAC.
- ▶ **PARAM 8000** was India's first indigenous supercomputer.

The pair to remember

PARAM is the Indian supercomputer; **C-DAC** is the organisation that developed it.

Software Roles: Match the Tool to the Job

Role	Example
Web browser	Firefox, Google Chrome, Microsoft Edge
PDF reader	Adobe Acrobat Reader
Remote-support tool	TeamViewer, AnyDesk, Chrome Remote Desktop

Match the software to its job, not to a similar-sounding name.

Associations at a Glance

Name	Correct association
PNG	An image format (Portable Network Graphics)
PDF	A fixed-layout document format by Adobe
.mdb / .accdb	A Microsoft Access database file
Firefox	A web browser by Mozilla
PARAM	A supercomputer by C-DAC
.xlsx	A Microsoft Excel workbook

Trap Alert: Confusions to Avoid

- ▶ .png is an **extension**; **PNG** is the **format** (TRAP-34).
- ▶ Firefox is a **browser by Mozilla**, not a PDF reader or a Microsoft product.
- ▶ **PARAM** is a supercomputer by **C-DAC**, not a file format.
- ▶ .mdb and .accdb are **both Access databases**.
- ▶ Adobe Acrobat Reader reads PDFs; it is **not** a web browser.

Lesson 55: Recall

- ▶ An **extension** is the letters after the dot; a **format** is how the data is stored.
- ▶ PNG = Portable Network Graphics, an image format; JPEG and GIF are image formats too.
- ▶ PDF = Portable Document Format, a fixed-layout format by Adobe; scanned PDFs need OCR.
- ▶ Office family: .docx (Word), .xlsx (Excel), .pptx (PowerPoint).
- ▶ CSV = Comma-Separated Values; TXT = plain text with no formatting.
- ▶ .mdb and .accdb are both Microsoft Access databases.
- ▶ Firefox is a browser by Mozilla; PARAM is a supercomputer by C-DAC.